

Exp12: Explore and implement Docker Swarm & compare with Kubernetes

What is Docker Swarm?

Docker Swarm is Docker's native container orchestration tool used to manage multiple containers across nodes.

Important Components

- ✓ Manager Node
- ✓ Worker Node
- ✓ Service
- ✓ Task (container instance)

Feature	Docker Swarm	Kubernetes
Setup	Very Easy	Complex
Learning Curve	Beginner-friendly	Steep
Scaling	Simple	Advanced
Networking	Simple	Powerful
Auto-healing	Basic	Strong
Industry Usage	Less	Very High
GUI	Limited	Many dashboards

Use **Docker Swarm** for:

- ✓ Small projects
- ✓ Learning
- ✓ Quick setup

Use **Kubernetes**:

- ✓ Production systems
- ✓ Large-scale applications
- ✓ Cloud environments

Step 1: Check Prerequisites

- ✓ Docker installed
- ✓ Docker service running

Check:

```
docker --version
```

```
mkdir exp12 && cd exp12
```

Step 2: Initialize Swarm

```
docker swarm init
```

Output:

Swarm initialized: current node is now a manager

Your system becomes a **Manager Node**

```
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$ docker swarm init
Swarm initialized: current node (1ze6gm9x1a9tteu0bfpwotgsy) is now a manager.

To add a worker to this swarm, run the following command:

    docker swarm join --token SWMTKN-1-3u0ua59w5ozk9fodwnutmw6zyjcgq1ftmoy8p535sqel9k894r-bref4y60xylsp6s0va4f0cwwv 172.17.4.121:2377

To add a manager to this swarm, run 'docker swarm join-token manager' and follow the instructions.
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$
```

Step 2: Check Nodes

```
docker node ls
```

Expected output:

Leader (your machine)

```
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$ docker node ls
ID                                HOSTNAME          STATUS    AVAILABILITY    MANAGER STATUS    ENGINE VERSION
1ze6gm9x1a9tteu0bfpwotgsy *      cse-B760M-H      Ready     Active           Leader             28.2.2
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$
```

Step 3: Create a Service

```
docker service create --name webapp -p 8080:80 nginx
```

This:

- ✓ Pulls nginx image
- ✓ Creates container(s)
- ✓ Exposes on port 8080

```
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$ docker service create --name webapp -p 8080:80 nginx
7sb48d0t5ciu6nd85zptysa
overall progress: 1 out of 1 tasks
1/1: running [=====>]
verify: Service 7sb48d0t5ciu6nd85zptysa converged
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$
```

Step 4: Verify Service

```
docker service ls
```

```
docker service ps webapp
```

```
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$ docker service ls
ID                NAME      MODE     REPLICAS  IMAGE      PORTS
7sb48d0t5ciu     webapp    replicated 1/1        nginx:latest *:8080->80/tcp
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$ docker service ps webapp
ID                NAME      IMAGE      NODE      DESIRED STATE  CURRENT STATE      ERROR      PORTS
ow1l4banp4ic     webapp.1  nginx:latest  cse-B760M-H  Running        Running 50 seconds ago
```

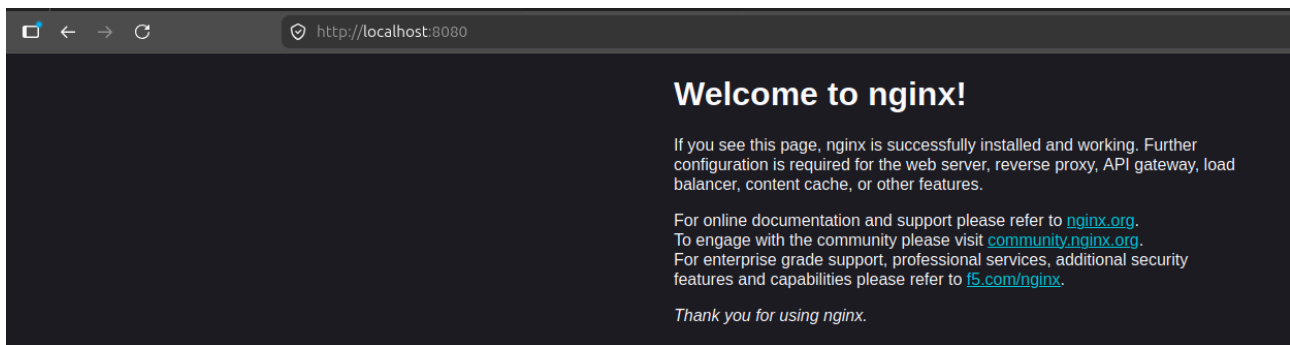
Step 5: Access Application

Open browser:

<http://localhost:8080>

Expected output:

Nginx welcome page



Step 6: Scale the Service

```
docker service scale webapp=3
```

```
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$ docker service scale webapp=3
webapp scaled to 3
overall progress: 3 out of 3 tasks
1/3: running [=====>]
2/3: running [=====>]
3/3: running [=====>]
verify: Service webapp converged
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$
```

Check:

```
docker service ps webapp
```

Now 3 replicas running

```
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$ docker service ps webapp
```

ID	NAME	IMAGE	NODE	DESIRED STATE	CURRENT STATE	ERROR	PORTS
ow1l4banp4ic	webapp.1	nginx:latest	cse-B760M-H	Running	Running 2 minutes ago		
lrdkq63kgxer	webapp.2	nginx:latest	cse-B760M-H	Running	Running 46 seconds ago		
3bj4eaxaw42e	webapp.3	nginx:latest	cse-B760M-H	Running	Running 46 seconds ago		

```
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$
```

Step 7: Observe Load Balancing

Refresh browser multiple times. Requests handled by different containers.

Right now all our replicas are serving the SAME default Nginx page.

So browser looks identical every time.

That is why we cannot visually observe load balancing.

Step 8: Prove Load Balancing Properly

We must make each container to display different content.

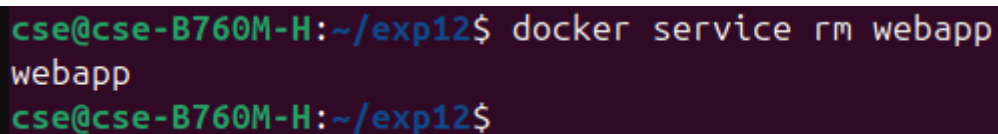
Then browser refresh will clearly show:

- ✓ container 1 response
- ✓ container 2 response
- ✓ container 3 response

Instead of default nginx image, let us create custom containers showing hostname.

Remove Existing Service

```
docker service rm webapp
```



```
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$ docker service rm webapp
webapp
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$
```

Create Service Showing Container Hostname

Run:

```
docker service create \
--name webapp \
-p 8080:80 \
--replicas 3 \
nginx sh -c "echo Container: \$(hostname) >
/usr/share/nginx/html/index.html && nginx -g 'daemon off;'"
```



```
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$ docker service create \
--name webapp \
-p 8080:80 \
--replicas 3 \
nginx sh -c "echo Container: \$(hostname) > /usr/share/nginx/html/index.html && nginx -g 'daemon off;'"
4t5mj5qqomyupp5cryee5e1p9
overall progress: 3 out of 3 tasks
1/3: running [=====>]
2/3: running [=====>]
3/3: running [=====>]
verify: Service 4t5mj5qqomyupp5cryee5e1p9 converged
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$
```

Each container writes its own hostname into webpage.

Example:

Container: abc123

Another replica:

Container: xyz789

Open Browser

Open:

`http://localhost:8080`

Refresh multiple times.

Now we observe

Page changes like:

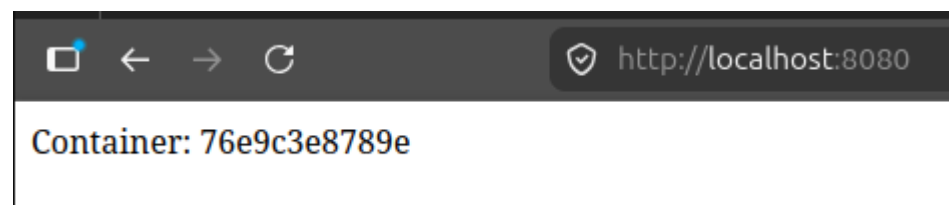
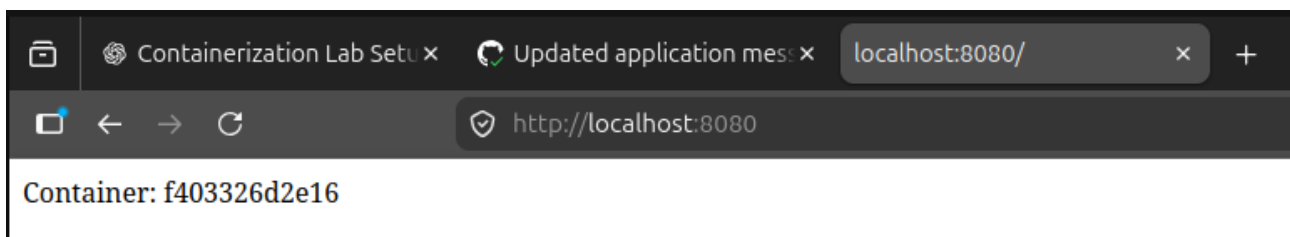
Container: x8k21

Refresh:

Container: p9l44

Refresh again:

Container: t7z91



Alternate method 1:

Run the following command in terminal and observe changes in itself.

```
curl localhost:8080
```

Alternate method 2:

```
docker service ls
```

```
docker service ps webapp
```

```
docker ps
```

```
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$ docker service ls
ID                NAME      MODE     REPLICAS  IMAGE      PORTS
4t5mj5qqomyu     webapp    replicated 3/3        nginx:latest *:8080->80/tcp

cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$ docker service ps webapp
ID                NAME      IMAGE      NODE     DESIRED STATE  CURRENT STATE      ERROR      PORTS
ttj29vp1pjop     webapp.1  nginx:latest  cse-B760M-H  Running         Running 4 minutes ago
k0hujql3mtt6     webapp.2  nginx:latest  cse-B760M-H  Running         Running 4 minutes ago
iinlgfap75vz     webapp.3  nginx:latest  cse-B760M-H  Running         Running 4 minutes ago

cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$
cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$ docker ps
CONTAINER ID   IMAGE      COMMAND                  CREATED        STATUS        PORTS      NAMES
f403326d2e16  nginx:latest  "/docker-entrypoint...."  4 minutes ago  Up 4 minutes  80/tcp     webapp.2.k0hujql3mtt602h9sxc58czp
743d12377763  nginx:latest  "/docker-entrypoint...."  4 minutes ago  Up 4 minutes  80/tcp     webapp.1.ttj29vp1pjopv42d2163k5szi
76e9c3e8789e  nginx:latest  "/docker-entrypoint...."  4 minutes ago  Up 4 minutes  80/tcp     webapp.3.iinlgfap75vzmpfv00bxf3fr

cse@cse-B760M-H:~/exp12$
```

Step 9: Remove Service

```
docker service rm webapp
```

Step 9: Leave Swarm (Optional)

```
docker swarm leave --force
```

Expected Output

- ✓ Swarm initialized
- ✓ Service created
- ✓ Application accessible
- ✓ Scaling works